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RF switch device including multi-width air gaps

Abstract

An RF switch device in a stacked configuration and a method of manufacturing the same seek to reduce or eliminate a voltage imbalance, a condition in which different voltages are applied to different stages of the RF switch device, by forming air gaps on or over corresponding gate electrodes, in which each of the air gaps in a single stage has a different width.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

(1) The present application claims priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0061299, filed on May 12, 2021, the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(2) The present disclosure relates to an RF switch device and a method of manufacturing the same and, more particularly, to an RF switch device in a stacked configuration and a method of manufacturing the same seeking to reduce or eliminate a voltage imbalance, a condition in which different voltages are applied to different stages or to different switches in a single stage, by forming air gaps having different widths on or over corresponding gate electrodes in a single stage.

BACKGROUND ART

(3) High voltage RF switches are used to be utilized in a variety of applications, such as tuning of high voltage RF antennas. RF switches typically include a plurality of transistors stacked in a series configuration between an RF source and ground, and include a companion bias circuit for biasing nodes of the plurality of transistors. Although the stacked configuration of an RF switch is suitable for many applications, parasitic leakage currents may begin to flow in and out of the plurality of transistors at extremely high peak RF voltages. The parasitic leakage currents may change the designed bias voltage values of the bias circuit.

(4) FIG. 1 is a schematic circuit diagram of a typical stacked RF switch device.

(5) Referring to FIG. 1, a conventional stacked RF switch device **9** is designed to connect multiple transistors in series to increase the breakdown voltage of the individual transistors and enable the individual transistors to withstand the high voltage operating conditions associated with RF switching. To be specific, the stacked transistors **T1**, **T2**, . . . **TN** are connected in series with each other. The stacked transistors may be controlled by a control signal **VG** at the gates of the transistors **T1**, **T2**, . . . **TN**. The control signal **VG** may activate the transistors **T1**, **T2**, . . . **TN** through corresponding gate resistors **RG1**, **RG2**, . . . **RGN**. When the conventional RF switch device **9** is exposed to a high peak voltage at radio frequencies, parasitic leakage currents **IL1** and **IL2** flow from respective drain and source terminals to body terminals **NB**.

(6) Therefore, in the stacked RF switch device **9**, ideally, as the number of individual switches increases, the breakdown voltage of the device should increase in proportion to the number of switches. However, a voltage imbalance in which different voltages are applied to different switches or stages in the device **9** may occur due to leakage current, etc. In addition, as the number of switches in the device **9** increases, the actual measured breakdown voltage shows a greater difference from the ideal breakdown voltage (breakdown voltage×the number of switches in a single stage). That is, the efficiency inevitably decreases compared to the number of switches.

(7) To solve such problems, the present disclosure concerns a novel RF switch device with an improved structure.

DOCUMENT OF RELATED ART

(8) Korean Patent Application Publication No. 10-2002-0078310, entitled “METHOD FOR FORMING METAL CONTACT IN SEMICONDUCTOR DEVICE.”

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(9) The present disclosure has been made to disclose solutions to the problems of the related art, and an objective of the present disclosure is to provide an RF switch device and a method of

manufacturing the same that prevent a voltage imbalance, a condition in which different voltages are applied to individual stages in an RF switch by configuring the widths of air gaps on or over gate electrodes in a single stage to be different.

(10) In addition, an objective of the present disclosure is to provide an RF switch device and a method of manufacturing the same that minimize parasitic capacitance in adjacent metal structures by configuring source extensions and adjacent drain extensions to not overlap along a first predetermined direction.

Technical Solution

(11) The present disclosure may be implemented by embodiments having one or more of the following configurations in order to achieve one or more of the above-described objectives.

(12) According to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, an RF switch device of the present disclosure includes a semiconductor layer; gate electrodes spaced apart from each other on the semiconductor layer; sources in the semiconductor layer; drains in the semiconductor layer; lower source contacts connected to corresponding individual ones of the sources; a first lower metal structure connected to one of the lower source contacts; lower drain contacts connected to corresponding individual ones of the drains; a second lower metal structure connected to one of the lower drain contacts; and air gaps on or over the gate electrodes, wherein at least one of the air gaps has a different width than other ones of the air gaps.

(13) According to one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, in the RF switch device of the present disclosure, the air gaps may have at least two widths.

(14) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, in the RF switch device, each of the air gaps may have a different width.

(15) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the RF switch device comprises a plurality of lower metal structures, and each air gap may be between adjacent ones of the lower metal structures.

(16) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the RF switch device may further include an upper source contact connected to the first lower metal structure; a first upper metal structure connected to the upper source contact; an upper drain contact connected to the second lower metal structure; and a second upper metal structure connected to the upper drain contact, wherein each of the air gaps may have an uppermost surface lower than a lowermost surface of the first and second upper metal structures.

(17) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, an RF switch device includes a semiconductor layer; gate electrodes spaced apart from each other in a single stage and on the semiconductor layer; sources in the semiconductor layer; drains in the semiconductor layer; a lower source contact connected to one of the sources; a first lower metal structure connected to the lower source contact; an upper source contact connected to the first lower metal structure; a first upper metal structure connected to the upper source contact; a lower drain contact connected to one of the drains; a second lower metal structure connected to the lower drain contact; an upper drain contact connected to the second lower metal structure; a second upper metal structure connected to the upper drain contact; and air gaps configured such that, in the single stage and on each gate electrode, at least one of the air gaps has a different width than other ones of the air gaps, wherein the first upper metal structure may include a source tab extending along a first direction and a plurality of source extensions extending in a second direction from the source tab, the second drain metal structure may include a drain tab extending in the first direction and spaced apart from the source tab in the second direction and a plurality of drain extensions extending in the second direction from the drain tab, and the source extensions and the drain extensions do not overlap each other along the first direction.

(18) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, each of the source extensions and the drain extensions may have a length equal to or less than half a distance between the source tab and the drain tab in the second direction.

- (19) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the RF switch device may comprise multiple stages, including the single stage.
- (20) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the air gaps within the single stage may have different widths to reduce or eliminate a voltage imbalance in the RF switch device.
- (21) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the source extensions and the drain extensions may not overlap each other along the first direction.
- (22) According to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, a method of manufacturing an RF switch device includes forming a gate insulating film on a semiconductor layer; forming a plurality of gate electrodes on the gate insulating film; forming a source and a drain in the semiconductor layer; forming a lower source contact on the source; forming a lower drain contact on the drain; forming a first lower metal structure on the lower source contact; forming a second lower metal structure on the lower drain contact; and forming air gaps, one each on or over a corresponding one of the gate electrodes, wherein the air gaps may have at least one width.
- (23) According to one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the method of manufacturing an RF switch device may further include forming a lower insulating film on the semiconductor layer; forming an intermediate insulating film on the lower insulating film; and forming an upper insulating film on the intermediate insulating film, wherein forming the air gaps may comprise forming a mask pattern exposing areas of the intermediate insulating layer in which individual ones of the air gaps are to be formed, and etching exposed areas of the intermediate insulating layer, wherein the exposed areas have at least one width.
- (24) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, in the method of manufacturing an RF switch device, the upper insulating film may be formed after forming the air gaps and may cover the air gaps.
- (25) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, in the method of manufacturing an RF switch device, the air gaps may have different widths.
- (26) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, a method of manufacturing an RF switch device includes forming a gate insulating film on a semiconductor layer; forming a plurality of gate electrodes on the gate insulating film; forming a source and a drain in the semiconductor layer; forming a lower insulating layer on the semiconductor layer; forming first contact holes in the lower insulating layer; forming a lower source contact and a lower drain contact in the first contact holes; forming first and second lower metal structures on the lower insulating layer; forming an intermediate insulating layer on the lower insulating layer; forming air gaps having non-uniform widths in the intermediate insulating layer; forming a first upper insulating layer on the intermediate insulating layer, the intermediate insulating layer covering the air gaps; forming second contact holes in the intermediate insulating layer and third contact holes in the first upper insulating layer; forming an upper source contact and an upper drain contact in the second contact holes and the third contact holes; and forming first and second upper metal structures on the upper insulating layer.
- (27) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, the method of manufacturing an RF switch device may further include forming a second upper insulating layer on the first upper insulating layer and the first and second upper metal structures.
- (28) According to yet one or more other embodiments of the present disclosure, in the method of manufacturing an RF switch device, the air gaps may have different widths.

Advantageous Effects

- (29) The present disclosure has the following effects by the above configurations.
- (30) The present disclosure can prevent a voltage imbalance, a condition in which the different voltages are applied to different individual stages or to different switches in a single stage in an RF switch by configuring the air gaps on or over gate electrodes in a single stage to have different widths.

(31) In addition, the present disclosure can minimize parasitic capacitance caused by adjacent metal structures by configuring source extensions and adjacent drain extensions to not overlap along a first direction.

(32) Meanwhile, it should be added that even if effects not explicitly mentioned herein, the effects described in the following specification expected by the technical features of the present disclosure and their potential effects are treated as if they were described in the specification of the present disclosure.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic circuit diagram of a typical stacked RF switch device;

(2) FIG. 2 is a plan view of an RF switch device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view AA' of the RF switch device according to FIG. 2;

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic plan view of a single stage of an RF switch device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure; and

(5) FIGS. 5 to 13 are cross-sectional views for reference for explaining a method of manufacturing an RF switch device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

MODE FOR DISCLOSURE

(6) Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in more detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. The embodiments of the present disclosure may be modified in various forms, and the scope of the present disclosure should not be construed as being limited to the following embodiments, but should be construed based on the matters described in the claims. In addition, these embodiments are only provided for reference in order to more completely explain the present disclosure to those of ordinary skill in the art.

(7) As used herein, the singular form may include the plural form unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Furthermore, as used herein, “comprise” and/or “comprising” refers to the specific existence of the recited shapes, numbers, steps, actions, members, elements and/or groups thereof and does not exclude the presence or addition of one or more other shapes, numbers, actions, members, elements and/or groups.

(8) In this specification, it should be noted that the individual components may be formed integrally or independently as necessary, and there is no limitation thereto.

(9) In the plan view showing the present disclosure, the x-axis direction is referred to as a “first direction” and the y-axis direction is referred to as a “second direction” (see FIG. 4).

(10) FIG. 2 is a plan view of an RF switch device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, and FIG. 3 is a cross-sectional view AA' of the RF switch device according to FIG. 2.

(11) Hereinafter, an RF switch device according to the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(12) Referring to FIGS. 2 and 3, the present disclosure relates to an RF switch device 1 and, more particularly, to an RF switch device in a stacked configuration seeking to reduce or eliminate a voltage imbalance (e.g., a condition in which different voltages are applied to different stages) by forming air gaps having different widths on or over individual gate electrodes in a single stage or series of switches. Here, “stacked configuration” means that two or more transistors are connected in series to increase the breakdown voltage of the individual transistors to withstand the high voltage operating conditions associated with RF switching. The term “stage” refers to an individual stacked configuration or series circuit in the RF switch. For example, a first transistor, a second transistor, a third transistor, . . . and an nth transistor may be connected in series to form a stacked

configuration, or a first stage, a second stage, a third stage, . . . and an nth stage may be connected in series to form a stacked configuration. In FIG. 2, a total of nine stages are illustrated, but there is no limitation thereto.

(13) Referring to FIGS. 2 and 3, the RF switch device **1** has a structure in which a plurality of gate electrodes are spaced apart in a single stage in a first direction (e.g., a stripe type), and a plurality of stages may be stacked in a second direction. The second direction may be orthogonal to the first direction.

(14) Hereinafter, the content of the configuration below the drain and the source in the active region will be omitted for convenience of description. For example, a drift region surrounding the drain and a body region surrounding the source may be below the drain and the source, respectively. A buried oxide (BOX) layer may be below the drift region and the body region.

(15) A plurality of transistors are in or on a semiconductor layer **101**. For example, the transistors may comprise field effect transistors. Each of the transistors may include a gate electrode **120**, a source **130**, and a drain **140**, which will be described in detail below. In addition, the switch device **1** may have a multi-finger structure in or through which the transistors are electrically connected to each other. Also, an insulating layer **110** may be on or over the semiconductor layer **101**, and the insulating layer **110** may comprise a plurality of individual insulating layers.

(16) For example, the insulating layer **110** may comprise a lower insulating layer **111**, an intermediate insulating layer **113**, and an upper insulating layer **115**. First contact holes **1111** for a lower source contact **131** and a lower drain contact **141** may be in the lower insulating layer **111**, second contact holes **1131** for lower portions of an upper source contact **135** and an upper drain contact **145** may be formed in the intermediate insulating layer **113**, and third contact holes **1151** for upper portions of the upper source contact **135** and the upper drain contact **145** may be in the upper insulating layer **115**.

(17) The gate electrode **120** is on or above the semiconductor layer **101**. In addition, a gate insulating film **122** is under the gate electrode **120** (e.g., between the gate electrode **120** and the substrate containing the source and drain). For example, the gate electrode **120** may have one end adjacent to the source **130**, and another end adjacent to the drain **140**. The gate electrode **120** may generally comprise at least one of conductive polysilicon, metal, conductive metal nitride, and combinations thereof, and may be formed by various known or to be known processes, such as CVD, PVC, ALD, MOALD, or MOCVD, and there is no limitation thereto. In addition, a gate spacer **124** that may comprise, for example, an oxide film, a nitride film, or a combination thereof may be on the outer (e.g., lateral) surface of the gate electrode **120** and/or the gate insulating film **122**.

(18) The source **130** is in the semiconductor layer **101** or in a layer of the substrate above the semiconductor layer **101**. The source **130** is a high-concentration impurity region, and may have, for example, a second conductivity type (e.g., an n-type or a p-type). The source **130** is connected to the lower source contact **131**. A first lower metal structure **133** is on and electrically connected to the lower source contact **131**, an upper source contact **135** is on the first lower metal structure **133**, and a first upper metal structure **137** are on or over the upper source contact **135**. The lower source contact **131**, the first lower metal structure **133**, the upper source contact **135**, and the first upper metal structure **137** may be in electrical communication with each other, and may comprise a metal such as copper, aluminum, or tungsten, but the scope of the present disclosure is not limited thereto.

(19) In addition, for example, the lower source contact **131** may be in a first contact hole **1111** and the upper source contact **135** may be in a second contact hole **1131** and a third contact hole **1151**, while the first lower metal structure **133** may be on the lower insulating layer **111** and the first upper metal structure **137** may be on the upper insulating layer **115**.

(20) The drain **140** may also be in the semiconductor layer **101** or in a layer of the substrate above the semiconductor layer **101** (e.g., the same layer as the source **130**). The drain **140** is a high-

concentration impurity region, and may also have the second conductivity type. A lower drain contact **141**, a second lower metal structure **143**, an upper drain contact **145**, and a second metal upper structure **147** may be on or over the drain **140**. The first and second lower metal structures **133** and **143** may be or comprise wires or lines in a first, relatively low layer of metallization, and the first and second upper metal structures **137** and **147** may be or comprise wires or lines in a second, relatively high layer of metallization. The lower drain contact **141**, the first metal structure **143**, the upper drain contact **145**, and the second metal structure **147** have a structure substantially the same as or similar to that of the lower source contact **131**, the first lower metal structure **133**, the upper source contact **135**, and the second metal layer **137**, and thus a detailed description thereof will be omitted.

(21) FIG. **4** is a schematic plan view of a single stage of an RF switch device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(22) Referring to FIG. **4**, the first upper metal structure **137** includes a source tab **137a** extending along a first direction; and a source extension **137b** extending in a second direction from the source tab **137a**. A plurality of source extensions **137b** may be present, spaced apart from each other in the first direction. Each such source extensions **137b** may have one side or end connected to the source tab **137a**. The second upper metal structure **147** also includes a drain tab **147a** corresponding to the source tab **137a**; and a plurality of drain extensions **147b**. The source tab **137a** and the drain tab **147a** are spaced apart from each other in the second direction.

(23) As an example, each of the source extensions **137b** and the drain extensions **147b** may have a length less than or equal to half the distance (e.g., the shortest distance) between the source tab **137a** and the drain tab **147a** in the second direction. Accordingly, the source extension **137b** and the drain extension **147b** do not overlap each other along the first direction, and this may minimize parasitic capacitances between the first upper metal structure **137** and the adjacent second upper metal structure **147**. That is, the individual source extensions **137b** and drain extensions **147b** may be in an alternating or “zigzag” pattern. Accordingly, the upper source contacts **135**, the upper drain contacts **145**, and the second and third contact holes **1131**, **1151** may also be in an alternating or “zigzag” pattern, and there is no limitation thereto. It should be noted that the lower source contact, the lower drain contact, the first lower metal structure, and the second lower metal structure are not shown in FIG. **4** for convenience of description.

(24) In addition, referring to FIG. **3**, an air gap **150** (e.g., containing air) may be on or over each of the gate electrodes **120** and may have a predetermined width W and a height H . The air gap **150** is a configuration that lowers the parasitic capacitance between the first lower metal structure **133** and the second lower metal structure **143**.

(25) Hereinafter, the structure of the conventional RF switch device and problems thereof, and the configuration of the air gap **150** according to embodiments of the present disclosure for solving these problems will be described in detail.

(26) Referring to FIG. **1**, the conventional RF switch device **9** is designed to connect multiple transistors in series to increase the breakdown voltage of the individual transistors to withstand the high voltage operating conditions associated with RF switching. To be specific, the stacked transistors **T1**, **T2**, . . . **TN** are connected in series with each other. The stacked transistors may be controlled by a control signal V_G at the gates of the transistors. The control signal V_G may activate the gates of the transistors **T1**, **T2**, . . . **TN** through the gate resistors **RG1**, **RG2**, **RGN**. When the conventional RF switch device **9** is exposed to a high peak voltage at radio frequencies, parasitic leakage currents **IL1** and **IL2** may flow from drain and source terminals to body terminals **NB**.

(27) Therefore, in the stacked RF switch device **9**, ideally, as the number of individual switches increases, the breakdown voltage of the device should increase in proportion to the number of switches. However, a voltage imbalance in which different voltages are applied to different switches or stages in the device **9** may occur due to leakage current, etc. In addition, as the number of switches in the device **9** increases, the actual measured breakdown voltage shows a greater

difference from the ideal breakdown voltage (breakdown voltage×the number of switches in a single stage). That is, the efficiency inevitably decreases compared to the number of switches.

(28) To solve such problems, in the present disclosure, the width W of each air gap **150** above the individual gate electrodes **120** in a single stage or series is different (e.g., from the other air gaps in the stage or series). For example, parasitic capacitances may be adjusted by adjusting the width W of at least one of the air gaps **150** on or over the gate electrodes **120** in a single stage or series. Accordingly, it is possible to adjust the impedance of each switch within a single stage, and to control the voltage applied to each stage or switch. Thus, the voltage imbalance of the switch device may be adjusted.

(29) Furthermore, when the switch device **1** is implemented in this way, the advantage is that there is no need to provide a separate compensation circuit including a capacitor to solve the conventional problems.

(30) FIGS. **5** to **13** are cross-sectional views for reference for explaining a method of manufacturing an RF switch device according to one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

(31) Hereinafter, a method of manufacturing an RF switch device according to the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. It should be noted that each process may be performed differently from the order described below, for example, a first process and a second process may be performed opposite to the order described, or they may be performed substantially simultaneously.

(32) First, referring to FIGS. **5** and **6**, the gate insulating film **122** and the gate electrode **120** are formed on or over the semiconductor layer **101**. For example, an insulating layer **123** for forming the gate insulating film **122** and a polysilicon film **121** for forming the gate electrode **120** are sequentially deposited on the semiconductor layer **101**. Alternatively, the insulating layer **123** and the polysilicon film **121** may be deposited onto an epitaxial layer grown (not numbered) on the semiconductor layer **101**. Then, a mask pattern (not shown) is formed on the polysilicon film **121** by conventional photolithography and development, and the exposed polysilicon film **121** and insulating layer **123** are etched by conventional dry or wet etching. Thereafter, the gate spacer **124** is conventionally formed on the outer (lateral) surfaces of the gate electrode **120** (e.g., by blanket deposition of one or more insulating layers, followed by anisotropic etching).

(33) In addition, referring to FIG. **6**, the source **130** and the drain **140** are formed. For example, the source **130** and the drain **140** may be formed (e.g., simultaneously) by an ion implantation process. In this case, the gate electrode **120** may be used as an ion implantation mask, but the scope of the present disclosure is not limited thereto.

(34) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **7**, the lower insulating layer **111** is deposited on the semiconductor layer **101**. Optionally, the lower insulating layer **111** is planarized by chemical mechanical polishing (CMP). After forming a mask pattern (not shown) on the lower insulating layer **111** so as to open positions where the lower source contact **131** and the lower drain contact **133** are to be formed, the exposed areas of the lower insulating layer **111** are etched to form the first contact holes **1111**.

(35) The lower source contact **131** and the lower drain contact **141** (comprising, for example, a metal such as copper, aluminum, or tungsten) are formed in the first contact holes **1111**. For example, a first metal layer **171** is formed on the lower insulating layer **111** to fill the first contact holes **1111**. Then, a planarization process is performed on the first metal layer **171** (e.g., by metal CMP) to expose upper surfaces of the lower source contact **131** and the lower drain contact **141**.

(36) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **8**, after depositing a second metal layer **173** on the lower insulating layer **111**, a mask pattern (not shown) is formed on the second metal layer **173** and an etching process is performed to form the first lower metal structure **133** and the second lower metal structure **143**.

(37) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **9**, the intermediate insulating layer **113** is deposited on the lower

insulating layer **111** and the first and second lower metal structures **133** and **143**. In addition, after forming a mask pattern on the intermediate insulating layer **113**, another etching process may be performed to form the air gaps **150**. The air gaps **150**, as described above, may be formed in multiple numbers within a single stage, and in the single stage, at least one air gap **150** has a different width W from the other air gaps **150** in the stage. The widths W of the air gaps **150** may differ as a result of forming openings with different widths in the mask pattern (not shown) on the intermediate insulating layer **113**. Accordingly, it is possible to control the parasitic capacitance between adjacent structures in the lower metal layer to a desired level. It is preferable to understand that the different widths W of the air gaps **150** correspond to differences in width outside the error range or margin in the process (e.g., of forming the mask pattern and/or of etching the intermediate insulating layer **113**).

(38) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **10**, after forming a first upper insulating layer **1153** on the intermediate insulating layer **113** (e.g., so as not to fill the air gaps **150**) and forming a mask pattern (not shown) for formation of the upper source contact **135** and the upper drain contact **145**, another etching process is performed to form the second contact holes **1131** and the third contact holes **1151**.

(39) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **11**, a third metal layer **175** is formed on the first upper insulating layer **1153** to fill the second and third contact holes **1131** and **1151**. Then, another planarization process (e.g., metal CMP) is performed on the third metal layer **175** to expose upper surfaces of the upper source contacts **135** and the upper drain contacts **145**.

(40) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **12**, after depositing a fourth metal layer **177** on the first upper insulating layer **1153** and forming a mask pattern (not shown) on the fourth metal layer **177**, the first upper metal structure **137** and the second upper metal structure **147** may be formed by etching.

(41) Thereafter, referring to FIG. **13**, a second upper insulating layer **1155** is deposited on the first upper insulating layer **1153** and the first and second upper metal structures **137** and **147**.

(42) The above detailed description is illustrative of the present disclosure. In addition, the above description shows and describes preferred embodiments of the present disclosure, and the present disclosure can be used in various other combinations, modifications, and environments. That is, changes or modifications are possible within the scope of the concept of the disclosure disclosed herein, the scope equivalent to the written disclosure, and/or within the scope of skill or knowledge in the art. The above-described embodiments describe various states for implementing the technical idea(s) of the present disclosure, and various changes for specific application field(s) and use(s) of the present disclosure are possible. Accordingly, the detailed description of the present disclosure is not intended to limit the present disclosure to the disclosed embodiments.

Claims

1. An RF switch device, comprising: a semiconductor layer; gate electrodes spaced apart from each other in a single stage and on the semiconductor layer; sources in the semiconductor layer; drains in the semiconductor layer; a lower source contact connected to one of the sources; a first lower metal structure connected to the lower source contact; an upper source contact connected to the first lower metal structure; a first upper metal structure connected to the upper source contact; a lower drain contact connected to one of the drains; a second lower metal structure connected to the lower drain contact; an upper drain contact connected to the second lower metal structure; a second upper metal structure connected to the upper drain contact; and air gaps configured such that, in the single stage and on or over each gate electrode, at least one of the air gaps has a different width than other ones of the air gaps, wherein the first upper metal structure includes: a source tab extending along a first direction; and a plurality of source extensions extending in a second direction from the source tab, the second upper metal structure includes: a drain tab extending in the first direction and spaced apart from the source tab in the second direction; and a plurality of drain extensions

extending in the second direction from the drain tab, and each of the source extensions and the drain extensions has a length less than half a distance between the source tab and the drain tab in the second direction.

2. The RF switch device of claim 1, comprising multiple stages, the multiple stages including the single stage.
 3. The RF switch device of claim 2, wherein the air gaps within the single stage have different widths to reduce or eliminate a voltage imbalance in the RF switch device.
 4. The RF switch device of claim 1, wherein the source extensions and the drain extensions do not overlap each other along the first direction.
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